

Verified

UEFA European Championship

The European Championship began in 1960 as the European Nations' Cup. Early final tournaments had only four teams. The modern EURO expanded to eight teams in 1980, sixteen in 1996, and twenty-four in 2016.

UEFA European Championship editions, 1960 onward

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
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Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>2024</u>	Germany	24	<u>Spain</u>	England	France	Netherlands	Spain 2-1 England	14 July 2024	Cody Gakpo; Harry Kane; Georges Mikautadze; Jamal Musiala; Dani Olmo; Ivan Schranz (Multiple, 3 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>2020</u>	Eleven European cities	24	<u>Italy</u>	England	Spain	Denmark	1-1; Italy 3-2 pens	11 July 2021	Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal, 5 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
<u>2016</u>	France	24	<u>Portugal</u>	France	Germany	Wales	Portugal 1-0 France (a.e.t.)	10 July 2016	Antoine Griezmann (France, 6 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>2012</u>	Poland and Ukraine	16	<u>Spain</u>	Italy	Germany	Portugal	Spain 4-0 Italy	1 July 2012	Mario Balotelli; Mario Gómez; Mario Mandžukić; Cristiano Ronaldo; Alan Dzagoev ; Fernando Torres (Multiple , 3 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.
<u>2008</u>	Austria and Switzerland	16	<u>Spain</u>	Germany	Russia	Türkiye	Spain 1-0 Germany	29 June 2008	David Villa (Spain, 4 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>2004</u>	Portugal	16	<u>Greece</u>	Portugal	Czech Republic	Netherlands	Greece 1-0 Portugal	4 July 2004	Milan Baroš (Czech Republic, 5 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
<u>2000</u>	Belgium and Netherlands	16	<u>France</u>	Italy	Portugal	Netherlands	France 2-1 Italy (golden goal)	2 July 2000	Patrick Kluivert; Savo Milošević (Netherlands; Yugoslavia, 5 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>1996</u>	England	16	Germany	Czech Republic	England	France	Germany 2–1 Czech Republic (golden goal)	30 June 1996	Alan Shearer (England, 5 goals)	—
<u>1992</u>	Sweden	8	Denmark	Germany	Netherlands	Sweden	Denmark 2–0 Germany	26 June 1992	Dennis Bergkamp; Tomas Brodin; Henrik Larsen; Karl-Heinz Riedle (Multiple, 3 goals)	▶  Tap to read the story Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>1988</u>	West Germany	8	<u>Netherlands</u>	Soviet Union	West Germany	Italy	Netherlands 2-0 Soviet Union	25 June 1988	Marco van Basten (Netherlands, 5 goals)	—
<u>1984</u>	France	8	<u>France</u>	Spain	Portugal	Denmark	France 2-0 Spain	27 June 1984	Michel Platini (France, 9 goals)	—
<u>1980</u>	Italy	8	<u>West Germany</u>	Belgium	Czechoslovakia	Italy	West Germany 2-1 Belgium	22 June 1980	Klaus Allofs (West Germany, 3 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>1976</u>	Yugoslavia	4	Czechoslovakia	West Germany	Netherlands	Yugoslavia	2-2; Czechoslovakia 5-3 pens	20 June 1976	Dieter Müller (West Germany, 4 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.
<u>1972</u>	Belgium	4	West Germany	Soviet Union	Belgium	Hungary	West Germany 3-0 Soviet Union	18 June 1972	Gerd Müller (West Germany, 4 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>1968</u>	Italy	4	<u>Italy</u>	Yugoslavia	England	Soviet Union	Italy 2–0 Yugoslavia (replay)	10 June 1968	Dragan Džajić (Yugoslavia, 2 goals)	—
<u>1964</u>	Spain	4	<u>Spain</u>	Soviet Union	Hungary	Denmark	Spain 2–1 Soviet Union	21 June 1964	Ferenc Bene; Dezső Novák; Jesús María Pereda (Hungary; Spain, 2 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
<u>1960</u>	France	4	<u>Soviet Union</u>	Yugoslavia	Czechoslovakia	France	Soviet Union 2–1 Yugoslavia (a.e.t.)	10 July 1960	Milan Galić; Dražan Jerković; Valentin Ivanov; François Heutte; Viktor Ponedelnik (Multiple, 2 goals)	—

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Spain

4

1964, 2008, 2012, 2024

Germany (incl. West Germany)

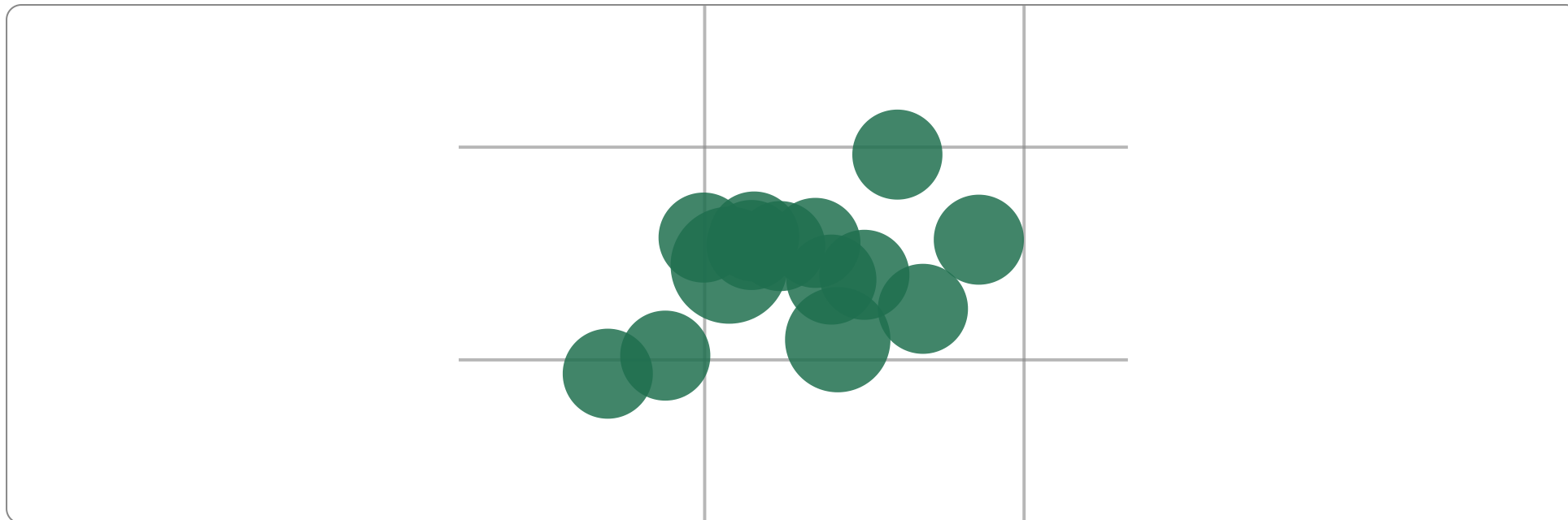
3

1972, 1980, 1996

Italy		2
1968, 2020		
France		2
1984, 2000		
Soviet Union		1
1960		
Czechoslovakia		1
1976		
Netherlands		1
1988		
Denmark		1
1992		
Greece		1
2004		
Portugal		1
2016		

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



Europe

France 3 times

1960, 1984, 2016

Spain 1 time

1964

Italy 2 times

1968, 1980

Belgium 1 time

1972

Yugoslavia 1 time

1976

West Germany 1 time

1988

Sweden 1 time

1992

England 1 time

1996

Belgium and Netherlands 1

time

2000

Portugal 1 time

2004

Austria and Switzerland 1

time

2008

Poland and Ukraine 1 time

2012

Eleven European cities 1

time

2020

Germany 1 time

2024

How it works

- UEFA national teams qualify over roughly two years of group matches before the finals.
- The finals open with a group stage; the best-placed teams in each group move on.
- From the quarterfinals onward it is a straight knockout: a single loss ends a team's tournament.
- The final decides the champion; no third-place match has been played since 1980 (see "Historical format note" below).

Historical format note

A third-place match was played through 1980. From 1984 onward, UEFA recognizes both defeated semifinalists without ranking them third and fourth. The table therefore uses neutral “other semifinalist” wording.

Player of the Tournament winners

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every EURO since 1996; no equivalent award existed at the four earlier editions.
- **1996:** Matthias Sammer (Germany).
- **2000:** Zinedine Zidane (France).
- **2004:** Theodoros Zagorakis (Greece) - captain of the surprise 2004 champions.
- **2008:** Xavi Hernández (Spain).
- **2012:** Andrés Iniesta (Spain).
- **2016:** Antoine Griezmann (France) - runner-up with France, the only winner of the award not to lift the trophy that year.
- **2020:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy) - the first goalkeeper to win the award.
- **2024:** Rodri (Spain).

Young Player of the Tournament winners

- UEFA has named a best-player-aged-21-or-under award at every EURO since 2016; no equivalent award existed at earlier editions.
- **2016:** Renato Sanches (Portugal).
- **2020:** Pedri (Spain).
- **2024:** Lamine Yamal (Spain).

Team of the Tournament winners

- UEFA's Technical Study Group has named an official Team of the Tournament (a "Best XI") at most EUROs since 1996, based on player performances across the whole competition. Two editions in that span - 2000 and 2012 - are deliberately excluded: UEFA published an extended squad-of-the-tournament (22 players in 2000, a full 23-player squad including three goalkeepers in 2012) rather than naming a single eleven that year, so there is no one clean XI to list without picking an arbitrary subset.

- **1996:** Andreas Köpke (Germany, goalkeeper); Laurent Blanc (France), Marcel Desailly (France), Matthias Sammer (Germany), Paolo Maldini (Italy); Paul Gascoigne (England), Karel Poborský (Czech Republic), Dieter Eilts (Germany); Alan Shearer (England), Hristo Stoichkov (Bulgaria), Davor Šuker (Croatia) - champions Germany supplied three, the most of any team, despite Italy's Maldini making the cut even though Italy itself was eliminated in the group stage.
- **2004:** Petr Čech (Czech Republic, goalkeeper); Traianos Dellas (Greece), Ricardo Carvalho (Portugal), Giourkas Seitaridis (Greece), Gianluca Zambrotta (Italy); Maniche (Portugal), Pavel Nedvěd (Czech Republic), Theodoros Zagorakis (Greece); Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal), Milan Baroš (Czech Republic), Wayne Rooney (England) - champions Greece supplied three, including Zagorakis, both captain and Player of the Tournament that year (see the sections above and below).
- **2008:** Iker Casillas (Spain, goalkeeper); Philipp Lahm (Germany), Carles Puyol (Spain), Carlos Marchena (Spain), Yuri Zhirkov (Russia); Luka Modrić (Croatia), Marcos Senna (Spain), Xavi Hernández (Spain), Hamit Altintop (Türkiye); Andrei Arshavin (Russia), David Villa (Spain) - champions Spain supplied six, the most of any team in this section.
- **2016:** Rui Patrício (Portugal, goalkeeper); Joshua Kimmich (Germany), Jérôme Boateng (Germany), Pepe (Portugal), Raphaël Guerreiro (Portugal); Toni Kroos (Germany), Joe Allen (Wales); Antoine Griezmann (France), Aaron Ramsey (Wales), Dimitri Payet (France), Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal) - champions Portugal supplied four, the most of any team; Cristiano Ronaldo's second selection on this list, twelve years after 2004.
- **2020:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy, goalkeeper); Kyle Walker (England), Leonardo Bonucci (Italy), Harry Maguire (England), Leonardo Spinazzola (Italy); Jorginho (Italy), Pierre-Emile Højbjerg (Denmark), Pedri (Spain); Federico Chiesa (Italy), Romelu Lukaku (Belgium), Raheem Sterling (England) - champions Italy supplied five, the most of any team.
- **2024:** Mike Maignan (France, goalkeeper); Kyle Walker (England), William Saliba (France), Manuel Akanji (Switzerland), Marc Cucurella (Spain); Rodri (Spain), Dani Olmo (Spain), Fabián Ruiz (Spain); Lamine Yamal (Spain), Jamal Musiala (Germany), Nico Williams (Spain) - champions Spain supplied six, the most of any team; Kyle Walker's second consecutive selection, the only player named in both 2020 and 2024 despite England not winning either tournament.



Winning managers

- **1960:** Gavriil Kachalin (Soviet Union).
- **1964:** José Villalonga (Spain).
- **1968:** Ferruccio Valcareggi (Italy).

- **1972:** Helmut Schön (West Germany) - also won the 1974 World Cup with West Germany, one of only a handful of managers to hold both titles.
- **1976:** Václav Ježek (Czechoslovakia).
- **1980:** Jupp Derwall (West Germany).
- **1984:** Michel Hidalgo (France).
- **1988:** Rinus Michels (Netherlands) - the architect of "Total Football", coaching the Dutch golden generation to their only European Championship title.
- **1992:** Richard Møller Nielsen (Denmark) - led a team that only entered the tournament after Yugoslavia's late disqualification.
- **1996:** Berti Vogts (Germany) - also won the title as a player in 1972, joining a small group of player-and-manager EURO winners.
- **2000:** Roger Lemerre (France).
- **2004:** Otto Rehhagel (Greece) - the German manager behind one of international football's biggest surprises.
- **2008:** Luis Aragonés (Spain).
- **2012:** Vicente del Bosque (Spain).
- **2016:** Fernando Santos (Portugal).
- **2020:** Roberto Mancini (Italy).
- **2024:** Luis de la Fuente (Spain) - the same manager who went on to win the 2026 World Cup with Spain.



Winning captains

- The captain is the player who lifts the trophy on the podium; every EURO-winning team has had one across all 17 editions.
- **1960:** Igor Netto (Soviet Union).
- **1964:** Ferran Olivella (Spain).
- **1968:** Giacinto Facchetti (Italy).
- **1972:** Franz Beckenbauer (West Germany) - also captained West Germany to the 1974 World Cup title, one of only a handful of players to captain a team to both trophies.

- **1976:** Anton Ondruš (Czechoslovakia).
- **1980:** Bernard Dietz (West Germany).
- **1984:** Michel Platini (France).
- **1988:** Ruud Gullit (Netherlands).
- **1992:** Lars Olsen (Denmark).
- **1996:** Jürgen Klinsmann (Germany).
- **2000:** Didier Deschamps (France) - also captained France to the 1998 World Cup title, then went on to win the 2018 World Cup as manager (see "Winning managers" above).
- **2004:** Theodoros Zagorakis (Greece).
- **2008:** Iker Casillas (Spain).
- **2012:** Iker Casillas (Spain) - the only player to captain a team through consecutive EURO titles, also captaining Spain to the 2010 World Cup between them.
- **2016:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal).
- **2020:** Giorgio Chiellini (Italy).
- **2024:** Álvaro Morata (Spain).

Memorable moments

- Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.
- Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.
- Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
- Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.
- The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
- Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.